

Advanced Verb Patterns

C1 · Renan the Teacher — English Language Academy

1. BRIEF EXPLANATION

C1 English requires precise control of complex verb patterns that go beyond simple "verb + infinitive" or "verb + gerund" choices.

- a) Verb + object + infinitive/gerund variations — some verbs change meaning depending on the pattern that follows.
- - remember/forget + to-infinitive (a task you need/needed to do) vs. + gerund (a memory of something already done)

I remembered to lock the door. (I did it, then remembered.) / I remember locking the door. (I have a memory of doing it.)

- - stop + to-infinitive (pause in order to do something else) vs. + gerund (quit doing something)

He stopped to smoke. (paused his activity in order to smoke) / He stopped smoking. (quit the habit)

- - try + to-infinitive (make an effort) vs. + gerund (experiment with something as a possible solution)

I tried to open the jar. (made an effort) / I tried using hot water to open the jar. (experimented with a method)

- b) Perfect infinitives and perfect gerunds — used to refer to an earlier action relative to the main verb.
- - Perfect infinitive: seem/appear/claim/pretend + to have + past participle

He claims to have met the president. (= he claims that he met the president, earlier)

- - Perfect gerund: after prepositions or certain verbs, to emphasize completion before another point in time.

She admitted having lied about her age.

- c) Causatives — have/get + object + past participle, used when someone else performs an action for you (arranged by you).

have something done: I had my car repaired. (I arranged for someone to repair it.)

get something done: I got my hair cut. (more informal/dynamic version of "have")

Compare with "make/have + person + bare infinitive" (to force/arrange for a person to do something): The manager had the staff redo the report.

2. EXAMPLES

- 1. Did you remember to send the invoice?
- 2. I remember meeting him at a conference years ago.
- 3. She stopped to answer her phone in the middle of the meeting.
- 4. He finally stopped biting his nails after years of trying.
- 5. Try turning it off and on again — it usually fixes the problem.
- 6. He seems to have forgotten our appointment.
- 7. She claims to have finished the report already.
- 8. They admitted having made a mistake in the calculations.
- 9. I had my kitchen renovated last spring.
- 10. We got the documents translated before the meeting.
- 11. He had his assistant confirm all the bookings.
- 12. She pretended not to have noticed the comment.

3. COMMON MISTAKES

- 1. Incorrect: I remember to lock the door yesterday, so it's definitely locked.

Correct: I remember locking the door yesterday, so it's definitely locked.

Why: This describes a memory of a completed action, so it needs the gerund, not the to-infinitive.

- 2. Incorrect: He stopped to smoke five years ago.

Correct: He stopped smoking five years ago.

Why: "Stopped to smoke" would mean he paused another activity in order to smoke — the intended meaning here is quitting the habit, which needs the gerund.

- 3. Incorrect: He seems to met her before.

Correct: He seems to have met her before.

Why: To refer to an earlier event, the perfect infinitive "to have + past participle" is required.

- 4. Incorrect: I had my car to fix last week.

Correct: I had my car fixed last week.

Why: The causative "have something done" uses the past participle, not a to-infinitive.

- 5. Incorrect: She admitted to lying to the police, before that day.

Correct: She admitted to having lied to the police before that day.

Why: To show the lying happened earlier than the admission, the perfect gerund is needed after "admitted to."

4. EXERCISES

- A. Gap-fill (choose infinitive or gerund, simple or perfect, as needed)
- 1. Please remember ____ (turn off) the lights before you leave.
- 2. I'll never forget ____ (see) the northern lights for the first time.
- 3. We stopped ____ (take) photos at the viewpoint before continuing the hike.
- 4. He finally stopped ____ (interrupt) people in meetings.
- 5. She claims ____ (invent) the recipe herself, years ago.
- 6. They seem ____ (know) each other already.
- 7. I had my suit ____ (tailor) for the wedding.
- 8. We got the roof ____ (repair) before winter.
- 9. He pretended ____ (not/notice) the mistake in the report.
- 10. Try ____ (restart) the router if the connection drops.
- B. Rewrite / Transformation
- 1. Someone repaired my laptop for me last week. (rewrite with a causative)
→ I had ____
- 2. It's possible that he already left. He seems... → He seems ____
- 3. She confessed that she had broken the vase. → She admitted ____
- 4. Someone is cutting our lawn every Friday now. (rewrite with a causative) → We get ____
- 5. I have a clear memory of visiting that castle as a child. → I remember ____
- 6. He paused his work in order to answer the phone. → He stopped ____
- C. Error Correction
- 1. I remember to visit Paris when I was ten.
- 2. She stopped answering the door — I think she's finally home again.
- 3. He claims meeting the queen once.
- 4. I had my hair to cut yesterday.
- 5. They admitted to lose the documents last year.
- 6. Try to turning the dial slowly.
- D. Guided Production
- 1. Write one sentence with "remember" (gerund) about a childhood memory.
- 2. Write one sentence with a causative ("have/get something done") about a service you've arranged.
- 3. Write one sentence with "seems/claims to have + past participle."
- 4. Write one sentence contrasting "stop + to-infinitive" and "stop + gerund" (two clauses).

5. ANSWER KEY

- A. Gap-fill
- 1. to turn off
- 2. seeing
- 3. to take
- 4. interrupting
- 5. to have invented
- 6. to know
- 7. tailored
- 8. repaired
- 9. not to have noticed
- 10. restarting

- B. Rewrite / Transformation
- 1. I had my laptop repaired last week.
- 2. He seems to have already left.
- 3. She admitted having broken the vase. / She admitted to having broken the vase.
- 4. We get our lawn cut every Friday now.
- 5. I remember visiting that castle as a child.
- 6. He stopped to answer the phone.
- C. Error Correction
- 1. I remember visiting Paris when I was ten.
- 2. She stopped answering the door — I think she's finally home again. (correct as written)
- 3. He claims to have met the queen once.
- 4. I had my hair cut yesterday.
- 5. They admitted to having lost the documents last year.
- 6. Try turning the dial slowly.
- D. Guided Production (sample answers)
- 1. I remember building sandcastles on the beach every summer with my grandfather.
- 2. I got my apartment painted right before I moved in.
- 3. She claims to have run a marathon without any training at all.
- 4. I stopped to check my phone, and later I finally stopped checking it every five minutes.

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